PORTLAND PUBLIC SCHOOLS
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STAFF REPORT

Date: **May 12, 2026**

To: Board of Education

CC: Dr. Kimberlee Armstrong, Superintendent

From: Isaac Cardona, Chief of Schools

Subject: Metropolitan Learning Center Mascot

BACKGROUND

Metropolitan Learning Center is an alternative school in Portland, Oregon that utilizes the diversity of the city and its resources to provide a challenging learning environment to empower students. Metropolitan Learning Center honors students ' identities, strengths, and learning styles so they can be themselves, find themselves, and find a sense of belonging in our school community. Metropolitan Learning Center uses courage, compassion, respect, self-discipline, and integrity as anchors for student behavior and learning. Metropolitan Learning Center builds relationships with each other and the world, in order to observe, create, imagine, and think critically about how to influence positive change.

In October of 2024, the Metropolitan Learning Center Site Council formally requested to begin the process to identify a mascot for their school. While 2.20.010-P Naming School District Property currently outlines a formal procedure for school or building name changes, which includes a written rationale, forming a committee, and presenting a proposal to the Board, there is no specific policy for mascot adoption. However, MLC followed a parallel process, which was rooted in transparency, inclusivity, and community voice.

Feedback gathered from across the school community strongly supports adopting a school mascot as a way to unify Metropolitan Learning Center's program, build identity, and enhance school spirit. A mascot would enhance representation, build tradition, and create fun, shared experiences.

After reviewing the steps the Metropolitan Learning Center community took to build consensus and arrive at a mascot, the Office of the Superintendent recommends the School Board approve the new mascot name chosen, the "**Monarch Butterfly**" unifying Metropolitan Learning Center's program.

RELATED POLICIES/BEST PRACTICE

A. 2.20.010-P Naming School District Property

B. 2.20.011-AD Procedures for Naming School District Property

FISCAL IMPACT

The fiscal impact will be minimal.

COMMUNITY ENGAGEMENT

The community engagement process was defined by quantitative and qualitative approaches to solicit feedback from the community, including surveys to students and staff and a final recommendation from the Renaming Committee.

- **Establish a Mascot Committee** comprised of students, staff, and community members.
- **Open a call for mascot submissions** from the Metropolitan Learning Center community.
- **The Mascot Committee reviews and selects 4 finalists**, based on alignment with the school's core values and character traits.
- **Facilitate a schoolwide vote** to select the final mascot.
- **Invite student and community artwork submissions** to visually represent the selected mascot.

Metropolitan Learning Community Mascot Naming Committee

- Suezann Kitchens - Former Principal
- Anna Sapaienza - 5th Grade Teacher
- Beriah Empie - RJ Coordinator
- Catherine Ordway - Former Teacher
- Katie Wong - Parent
- Shonda Murphy - Parent
- Ella Kennedy - Student
- Bella Kjellander - Student
- Jonah Freud - Student
- Josh Stilwell - Student
- Micaiah LeBron - Student
- Scarlett Hanson - Student

STAFF RECOMMENDATION

After reviewing the steps the Metropolitan Learning Center community took to build consensus and arrive at a new mascot, the Office of the Superintendent recommends the School Board approve the new mascot name chosen, the "**Monarch Butterly**" This decision will unify the Metropolitan Learning Center's program.

As a PPS Executive Leadership Team member, I have reviewed this staff report.

_____ *(Initials)*

ATTACHMENTS

A. Resolution